

Getting You Licensed and Cleared to Open

Prepared for [GROUP NAME]

Site [PROPERTY ADDRESS]

Attention [CONTACT NAME]

Dated [DATE] • valid [30 DAYS]

Thank you for bringing this to me.

Camden is where I built, so I'm glad the conversation found its way here. You have a location and you cleared your planning board, which is further along than most groups get before they call somebody. What sits in front of you now is the longer part... the City's endorsement, the state application, and everything that has to be true about your operation before the Commission signs off on it.

Here is what I would propose we do about that.

The Short Version

You hold a Camden location with planning board site plan approval. Still open ahead of you: the City resolution of local support, the New Jersey Cannabis Regulatory Commission license application, and the operational build that has to sit underneath both of them.

I would work alongside you across six phases, from a position audit through the day the Commission clears you to open. You sign, you fund, you own the business. I build the deliverables, prepare the filings, work the relationships, and sit in the rooms with you.

This engagement ends at inspection, and I want that clear up front. Getting you licensed, built to code, and through the Commission's inspection is one job. Turning that cleared room into a store that makes money is a different one, and I have set it up as a separate engagement you can take or leave once you see what your operation needs.

ADVISORY FEE	ENGAGEMENT TERM	WORKING CADENCE	MY ROLE
\$30,000	10 months	Weekly	Done-with-you
Released across five milestones	Ends when the Commission clears you to open	Standing call, plus async during business hours	You stay the applicant and the owner throughout

Where You Stand Today

Before anything else, an honest read of the board. Three of these I can confirm from what you have shared. The rest we settle in the first thirty days.

Camden location identified	SECURED
Planning board site plan approval	SECURED
Conditions and expiration attached to that approval	TO CONFIRM
Site plan approvals in New Jersey routinely carry conditions precedent and a clock. We need to know what yours says before we build a schedule around it.	
Site control (executed lease or deed)	TO CONFIRM
The Commission will not accept an application without proof of site control.	
Operating entity, cap table, operating agreement	TO CONFIRM
City of Camden resolution of local support	STILL OPEN
New Jersey CRC license application	STILL OPEN
Buildout, systems, suppliers, staffing	STILL OPEN

WORTH NAMING PLAINLY

Your planning board approval and the City's resolution of support are two different approvals from two different bodies. The Commission asks for the second one. Clearing the board was real progress and it is not the same thing as local endorsement.

This is the single most common place I see groups believe they are further along than they are, and it is usually discovered late, which is the expensive way to find out. We would close that gap in Phase 01.

How We Would Work Together

My role here is what I would call done-with-you. I am not handing you a binder and wishing you luck, and I am not signing anything on your behalf either. I build the documents, prepare the applications, work the municipal and supplier relationships alongside you, and I am in the room for the meetings that matter. You remain the applicant, the owner, and the decision maker on every call.

We would hold one standing working call each week for the length of the engagement, and I am reachable by email and text during business hours in between. Through the heavy stretches (the application build, the buildout, the run up to opening) expect that contact to run close to daily. Through the waiting stretches, expect it lighter. That is how the work actually flows, and I would rather set that expectation now than pretend the pace is flat.

The Six Phases

Each phase closes on something you can hold, not on a status update. The windows below reflect how these have actually moved, and they are estimates rather than commitments... the City and the Commission set their own pace.



First 30 to 45 days

Position Audit and Foundation

We start by establishing exactly where you stand, in writing, before a dollar goes anywhere near a contractor.

- Read the planning board approval in full and pin down its conditions, deadlines, and expiration
- Confirm what site control actually exists and whether it holds up for a state filing
- Review or form the operating entity, and settle the cap table and operating agreement
- Set designation strategy... Camden sits inside an impact zone, and how you are structured affects your standing, your fees, and how your application gets read
- Size the real capital requirement, start to finish, so nobody is surprised in month eight

DELIVERABLE

A written Position Report: everything you hold, everything missing, the critical path between here and open, and an honest go or no go.

01

Months 1 to 4

Site Control and Local Endorsement

Locking the two things the Commission checks before it reads anything else about you.

- Review the lease for cannabis contingencies and the terms the Commission expects to see, or negotiate and paper one if it is not executed
- Satisfy the planning board's conditions of approval
- Build and file the package for the City of Camden's resolution of local support
- Community outreach and letters of support from the neighborhood you will be operating in

DELIVERABLE

Executed site control, and a municipal endorsement package accepted by the City.

02

Months 3 to 7

The Application Build

The heaviest lift in the engagement, and the one that decides most outcomes.

- Ownership disclosures and background submissions for every principal
- Business plan and operating plan
- Security plan, built to the state's specification rather than to a template
- The full standard operating procedure set: inventory control and seed to sale tracking, diversion prevention, quality control, waste disposal, recordkeeping, secure transport, age and identification verification, employee training, and workplace safety
- Environmental impact plan and community impact plan
- Financial capability and source of funds documentation
- Workforce development and hiring plan

DELIVERABLE

A complete, submission ready application package, reviewed line by line before it goes anywhere.

03

Months 6 to 9

Filing and Response

Submission is the beginning of this phase, not the end of it.

- Submit and track the application
- Answer deficiency notices and follow up questions... this is where applications stall, and the turnaround windows are short
- Prepare you and your principals for any appearance or interview

DELIVERABLE

License issued.

04

Months 7 to 9

Compliance Build

Building the room the Commission approved, to the standard an inspector measures it against. Everything here is something they check.

- Floor plan, customer flow, and limited access and secure areas, built to match the plan on file
- Security system scope and installation oversight: cameras, alarms, safes, and access control to the state's specification
- Seed to sale tracking integration, installed and verified against a live test
- Required insurance coverage bound and on file
- Employee registration with the Commission, and your staff trained on the procedures we wrote in Phase 02

DELIVERABLE

A facility that matches its approved plan and meets every standard an inspector checks.

Inspection and Clearance

The last mile, run so that nothing on inspection day is a surprise.

- A full mock inspection against the state's checklist, run before the real one
- Every finding from the mock closed out and re-checked
- Certificate of occupancy coordination
- The Commission's inspection itself, with me on site

DELIVERABLE

Licensed, inspected, and cleared to open. This is where my work ends.

Investment and Payment Schedule

The fee is \$30,000 for the ten month engagement, released across five milestones rather than billed hourly or monthly. Most of it is tied to work I put in your hands.

Seventy percent sits against deliverables and the submission, all of which I control. Thirty percent rides on approvals granted by the City and the Commission, which none of us control. I would rather carry that risk alongside you than price it into the front.

PH.	RELEASED ON	AMOUNT
00	Engagement start, at signing	\$7,500
01	Position Report and municipal endorsement package delivered	\$6,000
02	CRC application submitted	\$7,500
03	License issued	\$5,000
05	Commission inspection passed, cleared to open	\$4,000
Total advisory fee		\$30,000

IF THE TIMELINE RUNS LONG

If the City or the Commission pushes past the ten months, the engagement continues month to month at \$2,000 per month, with thirty days notice on either side. I am not going to walk away from you at month eleven, and I also cannot commit to an open ended term at a flat fee. This is how we handle that honestly.

What the Fee Covers, and What It Does Not

Naming the second list is as important as the first one. These are real costs you should be budgeting for, and none of them run through me.

Included in the \$30,000

- All six phases as described above, through inspection
- Every document, plan, and standard operating procedure drafted and delivered
- Preparation and assembly of the full application package
- Attendance at municipal meetings, hearings, and the Commission's inspection
- The mock inspection, and closing out everything it turns up
- The standing weekly call and async access during business hours
- Local travel within the Camden and Philadelphia area

Not included

- State CRC application and annual license fees
- Municipal application and local licensing fees
- Attorney fees, and any legal work
- Architect, engineer, and general contractor
- Buildout, fixtures, and construction costs
- Security hardware and its installation
- Insurance premiums
- Software, point of sale, and platform subscriptions
- Rent, deposits, and property carrying costs
- Opening inventory and payroll
- Travel outside the Camden and Philadelphia area
- Everything past inspection: suppliers, banking, menu, pricing, hiring, and the opening itself (see below)

What Comes After Inspection

Passing inspection means you are legally cleared to open. It does not mean you are ready to make money, and I would rather say that plainly now than have you find it out in month three.

Opening services is a separate engagement. I would rather price it when we can both see what your operation actually needs than put a number on it today, before we know what your buildout, your team, or your capital position looks like.

What opening services covers

- Supplier relationships and your opening terms
- Cannabis friendly banking and payment processing
- Menu build, pricing, and margin structure
- Payroll, accounting, and back office setup
- Hiring, floor training, and scheduling
- Opening week plan, first orders, and floor coverage
- A delivery operation, if you decide you want one

How that works

We can talk about it any time after your license is issued, and there is no obligation in either direction. Nothing in this agreement requires you to use me for it, and I would rather you take the proposal above on its own merits.

If you would rather run the opening yourselves, that is a completely fair call. Everything I build in the phases above is yours, and it hands over cleanly to whoever picks it up.

Why I Am the One to Do This

I am Lemar Boone Jr., one of the founders and the COO of Cuzzie's Dispensary and Delivery here in Camden, and I run operations for a dispensary up in Newark.

I have done every step in this document, in this city, with this Commission. I wrote the plans, answered the follow up questions, worked the municipal process, opened the doors, and ran the floor afterward. Camden built, Camden run... that is not a tagline for me, it is the address on my filings.

I have also made mistakes that are worth paying to avoid. We discounted heavily out of the gate to win volume, we built a loyalty program that ate into a margin that was already thin, and we got squeezed. Behind on vendors, harder to buy product, harder to make money, and no room left to raise prices after holding them low for so long. We got stuck in a box. Most of what I know about pricing, vendor terms, and delivery economics came out of climbing back out of it.

That is the part someone who has only ever filed applications cannot give you. Plenty of people can assemble a binder. The operating plan, the security plan, and the procedures that go into your application read differently when the person writing them actually ran the floor they describe, and the people reviewing it can tell. It also means that when you do get to opening, I can tell you what your third month is going to feel like.

Terms at a Glance

TERM

Ten months from the date of signing, continuing month to month at \$2,000 per month thereafter if needed, with thirty days notice on either side.

WHERE THIS ENGAGEMENT ENDS

My work is complete when the Commission has inspected your facility and cleared you to open. Everything past that point sits outside this agreement and is quoted separately.

NO GUARANTEE OF LICENSE

The Commission and the City of Camden decide, not me. I can put you in the strongest position available to you, and I will not promise an outcome that is not mine to promise.

NOT LEGAL, TAX, OR ACCOUNTING ADVICE

You retain your own attorney and your own CPA, and I work alongside them. Nothing in this engagement substitutes for either.

NO OWNERSHIP INTEREST

This is a flat fee engagement. I hold no equity, no profit share, and no financial interest in your license, which keeps your ownership disclosure to the Commission clean and simple. That is deliberate, and it is worth something to you at filing time.

CONFIDENTIALITY

Mutual, and running in both directions, covering your business plans, financials, and site information as well as my methods and materials.

TIMELINES

Every window in this document is an estimate drawn from how these processes have actually moved, not a commitment. Government timelines are not mine to promise.

ADULT USE ONLY

This engagement covers a New Jersey adult use recreational retail license. It does not cover medical licensing, cultivation, or manufacturing.

Where We Go From Here

You have already finished the part a lot of groups never get through. You found a location and you got it past the board. What is left is a long road, but it is a known road, and I have walked it.

If this reads right to you, we would start with the Position Report. Two weeks from signing, tops, and you will know exactly where you stand and what the next ten months

actually ask of you. Even if you decide to go a different direction after reading it, you will be better off holding it than not.

Available for a call at any time if it would be useful. I am looking forward to seeing what you all build here.

Sincerely,

Lemar Boone Jr.

CO-FOUNDER AND COO, CUZZIE'S DISPENSARY AND DELIVERY · CAMDEN, NJ

[EMAIL] · [PHONE]

TO MOVE FORWARD

Countersign below and return. The first milestone invoice follows, and we open Phase 00 the same week.

AUTHORIZED SIGNATURE, [GROUP NAME]

PRINTED NAME AND TITLE

DATE

LEMAR BOONE JR.